



FLEET & SHORE PERSONNEL TRAINING

Security Awareness Training

The ISPS Code framework, the ship's security levels, and every crew member's role in preventing, recognising and reporting a security threat.



ISPS Code

SOLAS Ch. XI-2

STCW

Company SMS

What We Will Cover

01

Introduction to Maritime Security

Security vs Safety, and why every crew member has a security role

02

The ISPS Code Framework

Origins, scope and the three security levels

03

Ship Security Plan & the SSO

The ship's own security documentation and its security officer

04

Access Control & Restricted Areas

Controlling who comes aboard, and where they may go

05

Recognising & Reporting Security Threats

Spotting the unusual and getting the report to the right place

06

Piracy & Armed Robbery Awareness

High-risk areas, BMP measures and actions during an attack

07

Stowaways

Prevention, searches and handling a stowaway once found



SECTION 1

Introduction to Maritime Security

01

Why security is a distinct discipline from safety, and why it depends on every single person aboard.

Security Is Not the Same as Safety

Safety protects against accidents and natural hazards; security protects against deliberate, intentional acts by people.

- Safety (Emniyet) addresses hazards such as fire, flooding or mechanical failure; security (Güvenlik) addresses deliberate acts — theft, sabotage, terrorism, piracy or unauthorised access.
- The maritime security regime exists because ships and ports are attractive targets: high-value cargo, international movement, and access to major population centres.
- Security threats are adaptive — unlike a fixed hazard, a person seeking to cause harm will actively look for gaps in a ship's defences.
- Every crew member, regardless of rank or department, is part of the ship's security system simply by being alert to what is normal and what is not.
- A strong security culture does not mean suspicion of everyone — it means consistent, professional application of agreed procedures, every time, without exception.



See Something, Say Something

Most security incidents are preventable when small, unusual signs — an unfamiliar face, an unlocked door, an unattended bag — are reported early rather than dismissed.

Security Responsibilities by Level

The ISPS framework assigns clear security responsibilities at every level, from the Company down to each crew member.



Company Security Officer (CSO)

Ashore; oversees security for the fleet, liaises with authorities and approves the Ship Security Plan.



Ship Security Officer (SSO)

Onboard; implements the SSP, conducts drills and is the point of contact for day-to-day security matters.



Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO)

Coordinates security at the port facility interface and agrees the Declaration of Security when required.



Every Crew Member

Follows access control, reports anything unusual, and knows their role during a change in security level.



SECTION 2

The ISPS Code Framework

How a single international code came to govern security on every SOLAS ship and port facility in the world.

02

A Global Response to a Global Risk

The International Ship and Port Facility Security (ISPS) Code was adopted by the IMO to give the maritime industry a uniform security regime.

- The ISPS Code was adopted in 2002 as amendments to SOLAS Chapter XI-2, entering into force in 2004, in direct response to growing international terrorism concerns.
- Part A of the Code sets mandatory requirements; Part B provides recommended guidance on how to implement them.
- It applies to passenger ships, cargo ships of 500 GT and above on international voyages, mobile offshore drilling units, and the port facilities that serve them.
- The Code requires each ship to carry an approved Ship Security Plan, an International Ship Security Certificate (ISSC), and a designated SSO.
- Compliance is verified through Port State Control and flag state audits; a ship found non-compliant can be delayed, detained or denied port entry.



A Shared Obligation

ISPS places obligations on three parties at once — flag states, port facilities and the ship itself — so security only works when all three do their part consistently.

THREE SECURITY LEVELS

How the Ship's Posture Changes

The ISPS Code defines three security levels, each requiring a progressively higher standard of precaution.

SL 1

Normal — minimum appropriate protective security measures are maintained at all times

SL 2

Heightened — additional protective measures for a period of increased risk of a security incident

SL 3

Exceptional — further specific protective measures when an incident is probable or imminent

What Changes at Each Level

Each rise in security level brings concrete, visible changes to how the ship operates.

Security Level	Typical Additional Measures
Level 1 (Normal)	Standard access control, ID checks, restricted-area signage, routine deck patrols
Level 2 (Heightened)	Increased patrol frequency, 100% search of persons/baggage, limiting access points, extra watchkeeping
Level 3 (Exceptional)	Full lockdown of non-essential areas, compliance with specific instructions from CSO/authorities, possible evacuation planning



SECTION 3

Ship Security Plan & the SSO

The ship's own playbook for security, and the officer responsible for keeping it alive in daily practice.

03

What the SSP Actually Covers

The SSP is a confidential, ship-specific document approved by the flag state administration.

- It identifies the ship's security organisation, restricted areas, and the specific measures required at each of the three security levels.
- It sets out procedures for access control, handling security threats, communicating with the CSO and authorities, and conducting drills and exercises.
- The SSP is protected from unauthorised access or disclosure — it is not general reading material and must be kept securely.
- It must be reviewed, and amended where necessary, following an internal audit, an incident, or a change in ship operations.
- Every officer should know where the SSP is held and understand the sections relevant to their own duties, even without reading the full document.

The SSO's Core Duties

The SSO is designated by the Company and reports to the Master and the CSO on all security matters.



Implements the SSP

Ensures the plan's procedures are actually followed in daily operations, not just on paper.



Conducts Security Drills

Runs regular drills and exercises so the crew can execute the SSP under pressure, not just in theory.



Liaises with the CSO and PFSO

Coordinates security level changes, port-specific arrangements and the Declaration of Security.



Reports Security Incidents

Investigates and reports any breach, threat or non-conformity to the Master and Company without delay.

Key Security Records Onboard

These documents should be current, accessible to the SSO, and produced on request during a Port State Control inspection.

Document	Purpose
Ship Security Plan (SSP)	The ship's confidential, approved security procedures
International Ship Security Certificate (ISSC)	Certifies the ship complies with the ISPS Code
Continuous Synopsis Record (CSR)	History of the ship's flag, ownership and management
Declaration of Security (DoS)	Agreed security responsibilities between ship and port facility / another ship



SECTION 4

Access Control & Restricted Areas

04

Controlling who comes aboard, verifying who they are, and keeping them out of the spaces they have no reason to enter.

Controlling Who Comes Aboard

The gangway watch is the single most important security control point on the ship.

- Verify the identity of every person boarding against valid photo identification before granting access, without exception.
- Maintain a visitor/contractor log recording name, company, time in, time out and the purpose of the visit.
- Issue visitor passes or escort requirements as set out in the SSP, and never leave a visitor unescorted in a restricted area.
- Search baggage, packages and vehicles in line with the current security level, using consistent, documented procedures.
- A gangway watch that is distracted, unmanned even briefly, or waves people through as a courtesy defeats the entire purpose of access control.



No Exceptions

Access control applies equally to familiar faces, senior visitors and crew returning from shore — consistency is what makes the control effective, not politeness.

RESTRICTED AREAS

Spaces That Require Extra Control

The SSP designates certain spaces as restricted, with entry limited to authorised persons only.



Navigation Bridge & Bridge Wings

Controls the ship's navigation and communications; access limited to bridge team and authorised visitors.



Engine Room & Machinery Spaces

Contains critical systems and hazardous materials; entry limited to engine department and authorised personnel.



Cargo Spaces & Control Rooms

Protects cargo integrity and prevents tampering, concealment or unauthorised stowage.



Security & Safety Equipment Stores

Keeps SSP-critical equipment — CCTV controls, firearms lockers (where carried), keys — away from general access.

Keeping Restricted Areas Secure

Access control fails one small compromise at a time — consistency is what protects the ship.



Do

- Keep restricted-area doors closed and, where required, locked at all times
- Challenge anyone in a restricted area you do not recognise or who lacks authorisation
- Report a propped-open door or a disabled lock immediately
- Log key issue and return for any restricted-area access point



Don't

- Don't prop open a restricted-area door for convenience, even briefly
- Don't let a visitor or contractor move through the ship unescorted
- Don't assume someone in uniform or company clothing is automatically authorised
- Don't share access codes, cards or keys between individuals



SECTION 5

Recognising & Reporting Security Threats

Turning everyday alertness into a fast, accurate report that gives the ship time to respond.

05

WARNING SIGNS

What 'Unusual' Looks Like

No single sign proves a threat, but each is worth a closer look and, if in doubt, a report.



Unattended Items

A bag, package or piece of equipment left unattended in an unusual location, especially near restricted or high-value areas.



Unfamiliar or Evasive Persons

Someone aboard without a clear purpose, who avoids questioning, or who appears to be observing ship operations closely.



Tampering or Damage

Broken seals, forced locks, disturbed cargo or damage to security equipment such as CCTV cameras.



Suspicious Approach by Craft

Small boats approaching without clear purpose, at unusual hours, or on a closing course that does not respond to hailing.

What a Good Security Report Contains

A fast, accurate initial report allows the SSO and Master to make good decisions quickly.

- Report immediately to the Officer of the Watch or SSO — do not investigate a suspected threat alone or attempt to handle it yourself.
- State what you observed, exactly where and when, and whether the situation is ongoing.
- Avoid drawing attention to your observation if it could alert a person under suspicion before the ship is ready to respond.
- Do not touch, move or open a suspicious item — clear the area and await instructions.
- Every report, however minor it later proves, should be logged — patterns across small reports can reveal a bigger picture.



Better a False Alarm

No one is criticised for reporting something that turns out to be nothing. The only wrong choice is staying silent about something that felt wrong.



SECTION 6

Piracy & Armed Robbery Awareness

06

Preparing for, and responding to, one of the most serious security threats a merchant ship can face at sea.

WHERE THE RISK IS HIGHEST

High-Risk Areas Every Watchkeeper Should Know

Piracy and armed robbery risk is not uniform — it concentrates in specific, well-documented sea areas.

Gulf of Guinea

West Africa — a leading area globally for crew kidnap and vessel hijacking

Strait of Malacca

Southeast Asia — high vessel traffic density with recurring armed robbery incidents

Somali Basin

Western Indian Ocean — historic hijacking hotspot, still monitored under BMP guidance

Preparing the Ship Before Transit

Industry Best Management Practices (BMP) provide a proven set of measures for transiting high-risk waters.

- Register with the relevant regional reporting centre (e.g. UKMTO, MDAT-GoG) and report position in line with its guidance before and during transit.
- Rig physical barriers — razor wire, water spray, enhanced lighting — along likely boarding points before entering the high-risk area.
- Establish a citadel or safe muster point and brief the crew on the procedure to reach it if the ship is boarded.
- Increase lookouts, maintain radar and AIS vigilance, and keep the ship's speed as high as safely practicable through the area.
- Conduct anti-piracy drills before entering high-risk waters so the crew's response is automatic, not improvised, under real pressure.



Report Early, Report Often

An early, accurate report to the regional coordination centre and the Company can bring naval or coalition assistance long before an approaching threat becomes a boarding.

If the Ship Comes Under Attack

The overriding priority throughout an attack is the safety of the crew, not the protection of cargo or property.



Do

- Sound the emergency alarm and activate the Ship Security Alert System (SSAS)
- Muster the crew in the citadel or designated safe area per the SSP
- Maintain communications with the Company and the regional reporting centre where safely possible
- Follow the Master's instructions and the ship's pre-briefed attack response procedure



Don't

- Don't attempt to repel armed attackers with force unless life is directly threatened and no other option remains
- Don't stop broadcasting AIS or navigation lights unless specifically instructed under the circumstances
- Don't leave the citadel or safe area until the Master confirms it is safe to do so
- Don't resist a boarding once attackers are aboard — comply calmly and prioritise survival



SECTION 7

Stowaways

Preventing unauthorised persons from boarding, finding them if prevention fails, and handling a stowaway safely and lawfully.

07

PREVENTION

Keeping Stowaways Off the Ship

Prevention is far simpler, cheaper and safer than dealing with a stowaway discovered after sailing.

- Conduct a systematic pre-departure search of the ship, covering every space a person could conceal themselves, before every departure from port.
- Pay particular attention to high-risk ports and to spaces such as void spaces, chain lockers, funnel casings, lifeboats and cargo holds.
- Secure access points not in use — hatches, shell doors and pilot doors — and light the ship's exterior well during cargo operations.
- Coordinate searches with shore security and terminal staff where a formal search programme exists at the port.
- Record every search in the ship's log, including who searched which spaces and the time completed — this record matters if a stowaway is later found.

IF ONE IS FOUND

Handling a Discovered Stowaway

The Master must balance humane treatment with the ship's legal obligations and onward reporting requirements.

Step	Action
Immediate	Isolate and, if necessary, restrain safely; do not use excessive force; provide food, water and medical care
Documentation	Interview and record identity, boarding point and reasons given, retaining any documents found
Notification	Report to the Company, flag state, next port authorities and P&I Club without delay
Ongoing Care	Ensure humane treatment throughout; the stowaway remains the Master's responsibility until formally handed over

Working Within the Rules

Stowaway cases sit within international guidelines that balance security, humanity and practicality.

- IMO Resolution FAL.11(37) provides guidelines on the allocation of responsibilities for resolving stowaway cases between flag state, port state and the country of nationality.
- Repatriation can take weeks or months to arrange; the ship and Company should expect and plan for an extended period of responsibility.
- A stowaway must never be disembarked at sea, put ashore without proper authority, or otherwise treated in a manner that could endanger their life.
- Every stowaway case should be reviewed afterwards to identify how prevention measures failed and to strengthen the pre-departure search routine.



Security and Humanity Together

A stowaway case is a security event and a duty-of-care situation at once — firm procedure and humane treatment are not in conflict, and both are required.



COURSE COMPLETE

Security is not one officer's job — it is the habit of every person aboard, applied consistently, every single day.

Company Security Officer (CSO) — 24/7 contact

Ship Security Officer (SSO) — onboard point of contact

Fleet Safety Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr